NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 1 CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1945–1963

The Birth of the State of Israel, 1945–1963

British Mandate Collapse, King David Hotel, UN Resolution 181, The 1948 War, The Nakba & The Suez Crisis



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD • 14 MAY 1948 GPO-D597-087

Proclamation of the State of Israel, Tel Aviv Museum of Art

Rudi Weissenstein (1910–1969) • David Ben-Gurion, Executive Head of the World Zionist Organisation, reads the Declaration of Independence beneath the portrait of Theodor Herzl on 5 Iyyar 5708. Registered in the State of Israel Government Press Office archive under Accession Shelfmark GPO-D597-087.

HISTORICAL PRIMARY SOURCE EDEXCEL PAPER 2 MASTER ARCHIVE

PEARSON EDEXCEL OPTION P5 • KEY TOPIC 1 CONTENT OFFICIAL SPECIFICATION DIRECTORY

1 The British Withdrawal and the Creation of Israel

- Conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the **British Mandate**.
- Key events leading to the end of the **British Mandate**, partition and the creation of Israel, including the significance of the bombing of the **King David Hotel** and **UN Resolution 181**.
- Key events of the **Arab-Israeli war (1948–49)**.

2 Aftermath of the 1948–49 War

- Territorial changes and their impact. The refugee status of Palestinian Arabs.
- The creation of the **Israeli Defence Forces** and the **Law of Return**. **US aid** to Israel.
- Israel's relations with Egypt.

3 Increased Tension, 1955–63

- **Nasser** and Egypt's leadership of the Arab world.
- The events and significance of Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955 and **Sinai** in 1956.
- The events and significance of the **Suez Crisis (1956)**, including the formation of the **UAR** in 1958.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: INSURGENCY, UN PARTITION & WAR (1945–1947)

Living Timeline Protocol: Complete each milestone canvas below. Choose either **(A) Creative Sketch:** draw historical symbols, causal arrows, and dramatic scenes; OR **(B) Mind Map:** create a central concept bubble with key factual anchors.

JULY 1946 • The Bombing of the King David Hotel, Jerusalem

KEY TOPIC 1.1

Disguised as milkmen, militants from the Zionist paramilitary group Irgun, led by Menachem Begin, detonate 350kg of explosives in the basement of the King David Hotel. The blast collapses the entire south-west wing housing British military headquarters, killing 91 British, Arab, and Jewish staff and proving Palestine is ungovernable.

CREATIVE SKETCH / MIND MAP: *Sketch the hotel facade & milk churn blast wave, OR mindmap 3 reasons Palestine became ungovernable.* DUAL-CODING

JULY 1947 • The SS Exodus Affair & Surrender to the UN

KEY TOPIC 1.1

Royal Navy warships intercept the refugee ship SS Exodus carrying 4,500 Holocaust survivors off Haifa and forcibly return them to displaced persons camps in Germany. The resulting global PR disaster outrages US President Truman, exhausts British resolve, and leads Foreign Secretary Ernest Bevin to surrender the Mandate to UNSCOP and the United Nations.

CREATIVE SKETCH / MIND MAP: *Sketch the SS Exodus flanked by Royal Navy destroyers, OR map the international PR backlash and UN referral.* DUAL-CODING

NOV 1947 • UN Resolution 181 (The Palestine Partition Plan)

KEY TOPIC 1.2

The United Nations General Assembly votes 33 to 13 to terminate the British Mandate and partition Palestine into separate Arab and Jewish states, with Jerusalem placed under international United Nations trusteeship. The Jewish Agency accepts; all Arab nations reject the plan, triggering civil war.

CREATIVE SKETCH / MIND MAP: *Sketch the partitioned Arab (43%) & Jewish (56%) map zones, OR map the contrasting Arab/Jewish reactions.* DUAL-CODING

"Remember: The exam strictly begins in 1945 — master the post-war crisis and Mandate collapse."

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: STATEHOOD, THE NAKBA & THE SUEZ CRISIS (1948–1956)

Living Timeline Protocol: Complete each milestone canvas below. Choose either **(A) Creative Sketch:** draw historical symbols, causal arrows, and dramatic scenes; OR **(B) Mind Map:** create a central concept bubble with key factual anchors.

MAY 1948 • Declaration of Independence & The 1948–49 Arab-Israeli War

KEY TOPIC 1.2

On 14 May 1948, David Ben-Gurion proclaims the State of Israel as British forces complete their evacuation. The next day, five Arab states (Egypt, Transjordan, Syria, Iraq, Lebanon) invade. Israel survives initial assaults, re-arms during the June UN truce via Czechoslovakia, and signs armistices along the 1949 Green Line.

CREATIVE SKETCH / MIND MAP: *Sketch Ben-Gurion declaring statehood beneath Star of David, OR map the 5 Arab invasion arrows repelled to Green Line.* DUAL-CODING

1948–1950 • The Palestinian Refugee Crisis (Al-Nakba) & Law of Return

KEY TOPIC 1.3

Approximately 700,000 Palestinian Arabs are displaced into permanent exile (Al-Nakba), supported by the newly formed UNRWA in Gaza, the West Bank, Lebanon, and Syria. Simultaneously, Israel passes the 1950 Law of Return, absorbing over 680,000 Holocaust survivors and Mizrahi Jewish refugees from Arab lands.

CREATIVE SKETCH / MIND MAP: *Sketch split diagram: Palestinian refugee tents / UNRWA ration cards vs immigrant ships under 1950 Law of Return.* DUAL-CODING

OCT–NOV 1956 • The Suez Crisis & The Protocol of Sèvres

KEY TOPIC 1.4

Following Nasser's nationalisation of the Suez Canal, Britain, France, and Israel secretly sign the Protocol of Sèvres. Israel invades the Sinai on 29 October; Britain and France intervene to "separate the combatants" and seize the canal. US financial ultimatums force a humiliating Anglo-French withdrawal, leaving UNEF peacekeepers in Sinai.

CREATIVE SKETCH / MIND MAP: *Sketch tripartite causal flowchart: Israeli Sinai strike → Anglo-French canal landing → US ultimatum.* DUAL-CODING

Why did Britain abandon its Mandate in Palestine and hand the problem to the UN?

Key Topic 1.1: The Collapse of the British Mandate & UN Partition (1945–1947)

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1945–1946 • Why did Bevin strictly enforce the 1,500 monthly refugee immigration limit?

- 250,000 Displaced Holocaust Survivors
- Threat to Middle East Oil Access
- Truman Demands 100,000 Visas

2 Nov 1945 – 1946 • How did Zionist paramilitaries paralyze British infrastructure in Palestine?

- Night of the Trains (153 Rail Cuts)
- Blowing Up Radar Stations
- Sabotage of Bridges & Pipelines

3 22 July 1946 • Why did targeting the King David Hotel prove Palestine was ungovernable?

- British Military & Civil HQ Destroyed
- 91 Government Staff Killed
- Soldiers Trapped Behind Barbed Wire

4 July 1947 • Why did the Sergeants Affair trigger public outrage in Britain?

- Hanged in Eucalyptus Grove
- Booby-Trapped Wire Explosives
- Anti-Jewish Riots Across the UK

5 Summer–Nov 1947 • How did the SS Exodus crisis force Britain to surrender the Mandate to the UN?

- 4,500 Holocaust Survivors Turned Back
- Royal Navy Forced Return to Germany
- US Outrage & International Outcry

"Saying 'Britain was tired after the war' is true, but the examiner expects 8 marks of depth!"

• QUESTION 1(A): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS] [4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of the bombing of the King David Hotel (July 1946).

P-F-C Stems: One major consequence was that... • Specifically, this occurred when... • Consequently, this directly led to...

• QUESTION 1(B): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS] [4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of the SS Exodus affair (July 1947).

P-F-C Stems: Another key consequence was that... • Specifically, this was evident because... • Consequently, this altered relations...

Question 3: Explain the Importance [8 marks • 12 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT • 8 MARKS

Explain the importance of the bombing of the King David Hotel (July 1946) for the British decision to withdraw from Palestine. [8 marks]

Structure across two distinct analytical aspects: • Destruction of British Military HQ & Security Breakdown • Domestic Economic Exhaustion & Handover to the UN

1. POINT 1: SECURITY BREAKDOWN	2. POINT 2: DOMESTIC CRISIS	3. EVALUATIVE SUMMARY: UN REFERRAL

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason this was important was that... • For example, ... • This mattered because... • Another key factor was... • In particular, ... • Overall, the most decisive impact was... because...*

"Grade 9 formula: Point, Fact, Consequence — never leave an assertion without its factual anchor."

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3
Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.1). In Milestones 1 & 2, sketch the shattered south-west wing of the King David Hotel and the SS Exodus refugee ship.

How was the State of Israel established and defended during the 1948–49 War?

Key Topic 1.2: UN Resolution 181, Independence & The 1948–49 War (1947–1949)

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 Dec 1947 – May 1948 • Why did Plan Dalet ignite intense fighting along the Tel Aviv–Jerusalem corridor?

- Relieving Blockaded Enclaves
- Capture of Arab Villages
- Deir Yassin & Hadassah Ambush

2 14 May 1948 • Why did Ben-Gurion proclaim statehood hours before the British Mandate expired?

- Reading Declaration in Tel Aviv
- Immediate Truman Recognition
- Legitimacy to Receive Weapons

3 15 May 1948 • Which strategic sectors did the five invading Arab armies seize in May 1948?

- Jordanian Arab Legion Seizes Old City
- Egyptian Advance Through Negev
- Syrian Thrust in the North

4 June–July 1948 • How did the 4-week UN truce enable Israel to decisively shift military momentum?

- Illegal Czechoslovakian Arms Airlift
- Forces Doubled to 108,000 Troops
- Consolidation of the Unified IDF

5 Feb–July 1949 • How did the 1949 Green Line transform the territory allocated by the UN?

- Israel Captures 79% of Palestine
- Jordanian Annexation of West Bank
- Egyptian Control of Gaza Strip

"UN Resolution 181 gave each side a jigsaw puzzle; neither side liked the picture."

• QUESTION 1(A): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS] [4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of United Nations Resolution 181 (November 1947).

P-F-C Stems: One major consequence was that... • Specifically, this occurred when... • Consequently, this directly led to...

• QUESTION 1(B): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS] [4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of the first United Nations truce (June–July 1948).

P-F-C Stems: Another key consequence was that... • Specifically, this was evident because... • Consequently, this altered relations...

Question 2: Narrative Account [8 marks • 12 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT • 8 MARKS

Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the 1948–49 Arab-Israeli War from the declaration of the State of Israel to the 1949 Armistice Agreements. [8 marks]

You may use the following in your answer: • David Ben-Gurion's Declaration of Independence (14 May 1948) • The first UN truce and Czechoslovakian arms shipments (June 1948) • *You must also use information of your own.*

1. PHASE 1: ARAB INVASION	2. PHASE 2: TURNING POINT TRUCE	3. PHASE 3: ISRAELI OFFENSIVES

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main event was that... • For example, ... • This led directly to... • The next major development was... • In particular, ... • Overall, this culminated in... because...*

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3
Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.2). In Milestones 3 & 4, sketch the UN Partition map divisions and the five Arab invasion routes crossing Israel's borders.

Why did the 1948–49 War create an enduring refugee crisis and regional militarism?

Key Topic 1.3: The Refugee Crisis (Nakba) & The New Israeli State (1948–1954)

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1948–1949 • Why is the cause of the 1948 Palestinian refugee flight (al-Nakba) contested?

- 700,000 Civilians Displaced
- Debate: Panic Flight vs Expulsion
- Over 400 Abandoned Villages

2 Dec 1949 • Why did Arab states and Israel disagree over UN Resolution 194 and UNRWA?

- Palestinian "Right of Return" Demand
- Israel Refuses Arab Majority Threat
- Tents in Gaza & West Bank Camps

3 July 1950 • How did the Law of Return transform Israel's demographics and economy by 1953?

- Automatic Citizenship Guaranteed
- Population Doubles to 1.5 Million
- Severe Housing & Rationing Crisis

4 1948–1953 • Why was universal military conscription and US aid essential for Israeli survival?

- Surrounded by Hostile Arab States
- Serving Two Years with Weapons
- Vital Financial Lifeline from Washington

5 1949–1954 • Why did cross-border infiltration trigger Sharon's Unit 101 raid on Qibya?

- Fedayeen Raids & Crop Harvesting
- Dynamiting of 45 Village Houses
- 69 Palestinian Civilians Killed

"Calling 700,000 displaced refugees 'a minor consequence' is a guaranteed ticket to a Level 1 mark."

• QUESTION 1(A): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS] [4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of the 1948–49 War for Palestinian Arabs.

P-F-C Stems: One major consequence was that... • Specifically, this occurred when... • Consequently, this directly led to...

• QUESTION 1(B): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS] [4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of the Israeli Law of Return (1950).

P-F-C Stems: Another key consequence was that... • Specifically, this was evident because... • Consequently, this altered relations...

Question 3: Explain the Importance [8 marks • 12 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT • 8 MARKS

Explain the importance of the Law of Return (1950) for the development of the new State of Israel in the aftermath of the 1948–49 War. [8 marks]

Structure across two distinct analytical aspects: • Demographic Expansion & Absorbing Holocaust Survivors and Mizrahi Jews • Military Manpower & National Consolidation against Arab Neighbours

1. POINT 1: DEMOGRAPHIC GROWTH	2. POINT 2: MILITARY & BORDER SECURITY	3. EVALUATIVE SUMMARY: STATE IDENTITY

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason this was important was that... • For example, ... • This mattered because... • Another key factor was... • In particular, ... • Overall, the most decisive impact was... because...*

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3
Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.3). In Milestone 5, sketch the overcrowded UNRWA refugee tents alongside the cargo ships arriving in Haifa with Jewish immigrants.

Why did Gamal Abdel Nasser's nationalisation of the Suez Canal trigger international war in 1956?

Key Topic 1.4: Nasser, Border Tension & The 1956 Suez Crisis (1955–1958)

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 Feb 1955 • Why did Ben-Gurion's Gaza raid convince Nasser he needed modern heavy weapons?	
• 37 Egyptian Soldiers Killed	
• Humiliation of Egyptian Military	
• Western Arms Boycott Refusal	

2 Sept 1955 • Why did the Czech arms deal alarm Britain, France, and Israel in 1955?	
• MiG-15 Jet Fighters & Heavy Tanks	
• Western Arms Monopoly Broken	
• Upsetting Regional Balance with Israel	

3 26 July 1956 • Why did Britain and France view canal nationalisation as an intolerable threat?	
• Vital Maritime Oil Route to Gulf	
• Tolls Used to Fund Aswan Dam	
• Threat to European Imperial Prestige	

4 Oct–Nov 1956 • How did the secret Protocol of Sèvres orchestrate a pretext for invading Egypt?	
• Secret Tripartite Alliance in Paris	
• Pre-Planned Anglo-French Ultimatum	
• Dropping Paratroopers on Port Said	

5 Nov 1956 – 1958 • Why did the Suez Crisis end in political triumph for Nasser despite military defeat?	
• Eisenhower Threatens British Pound	
• Humiliating Anglo-French Retreat	
• Champion of Anti-Imperialism (UAR)	

"Eden thought Nasser was Mussolini on the Nile; Eisenhower promptly reminded Eden what year it was."

• QUESTION 1(A): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS] [4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of the Israeli raid on Gaza (February 1955).

P-F-C Stems: One major consequence was that... • Specifically, this occurred when... • Consequently, this directly led to...

• QUESTION 1(B): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS] [4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of the 1956 Suez Crisis for Britain and France as global powers.

P-F-C Stems: Another key consequence was that... • Specifically, this was evident because... • Consequently, this altered relations...

Question 2: Narrative Account [8 marks • 12 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT • 8 MARKS

Write a narrative account analysing the events of the 1956 Suez Crisis from the nationalisation of the canal to the withdrawal of Anglo-French forces. [8 marks]

You may use the following in your answer: • President Nasser nationalises the Suez Canal (26 July 1956) • The secret Protocol of Sèvres and Israeli invasion of Sinai (October 1956) • *You must also use information of your own.*

1. PHASE 1: CATALYST & NATIONALISATION	2. PHASE 2: SECRET SÈVRES CONSPIRACY	3. PHASE 3: SUPERPOWER ULTIMATUM

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main event was that... • For example, ... • This led directly to... • The next major development was... • In particular, ... • Overall, this culminated in... because...*

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3
Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.4). In Milestone 6, sketch the tripartite causal flowchart: Israeli Sinai strike → Anglo-French canal landing → US economic ultimatum.

PUPIL NAME: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** ☐

#	ENQUIRY / LESSON ASSESSMENT	DO NOW (10M)	Q1(A) (4M)	Q1(B) (4M)	EXTENDED (8M)	LESSON TOTAL
1	**KT1.1: Mandate Collapse & King David** *"Why did the British Mandate collapse and how was the State of Israel established?"* **HW Set:** _____ **Due:** _____ ☐ *Read & Quizzed* **Home Quiz:** _____ / 10 **Parent Sign:** _____	_____ / 10	_____ / 4	_____ / 4	Q3: _____ / 8	_____ / 26
2	**KT1.2: UN Res 181 & The 1948–49 War** *"What were the military, territorial, and geopolitical turning points of the 1948–49 War?"* **HW Set:** _____ **Due:** _____ ☐ *Read & Quizzed* **Home Quiz:** _____ / 10 **Parent Sign:** _____	_____ / 10	_____ / 4	_____ / 4	Q2: _____ / 8	_____ / 26
3	**KT1.3: Nakba & The Law of Return** *"How did the Palestinian refugee crisis and the Law of Return transform the demographic landscape?"* **HW Set:** _____ **Due:** _____ ☐ *Read & Quizzed* **Home Quiz:** _____ / 10 **Parent Sign:** _____	_____ / 10	_____ / 4	_____ / 4	Q3: _____ / 8	_____ / 26
4	**KT1.4: Nasser & The 1956 Suez Crisis** *"Why did the nationalisation of the Suez Canal trigger a global superpower crisis?"* **HW Set:** _____ **Due:** _____ ☐ *Read & Quizzed* **Home Quiz:** _____ / 10 **Parent Sign:** _____	_____ / 10	_____ / 4	_____ / 4	Q2: _____ / 8	_____ / 26